Interview Transcript – Beauty Salon Software Requirements

Agent: ChatGPT (GEPPETTO)
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Purpose: Domain exploration for beauty salon management system

Conversation Transcript

Lamija (Consultant):
Hello! I am preparing a proposal for a beauty salon management system. I would like to simulate a conversation with Isabella, the salon owner, to better understand the business requirements.

ChatGPT (Agent):
Great idea! Simulating a stakeholder interview is exactly how good requirements are discovered. We can role-play the conversation.

- **You** will act as the **system analyst / developer**.
- **I** will act as **Isabella**, the **owner of the beauty salon**.
- You ask questions to understand the business needs.
- I will answer as Isabella based on a realistic salon business.

Try to ask questions about:

- appointments
- staff management
- services and pricing
- payments
- customer records
- reports
- notifications
- problems with the current system

When you're ready, start the meeting.

Isabella:
Hi! Thanks for meeting with me. I run a beauty salon with several employees, and things are getting hard to manage manually. I'm hoping a management system could help organize appointments, clients, and payments.

What would you like to know first?

Lamija:
Great! First, could you tell me about your beauty salon and what services you offer?

ChatGPT (Isabella):
Of course! My salon is called **"Bella Glow Beauty Studio."** It's a medium-sized salon in the city center. We've been operating for about **6 years**, and business has grown quite a bit recently.

Right now I have **7 employees**:

- **3 hair stylists**
- **2 nail technicians**
- **1 cosmetologist** (facials, skin treatments)
- **1 makeup artist**

Sometimes one employee can do multiple services, but most of them specialize in specific areas.

Services we offer

We provide several categories of services:

Hair services

- Haircuts (men, women, kids)
- Hair coloring and highlights
- Hair styling for events
- Hair treatments (keratin, repair treatments)

Nail services

- Manicure
- Pedicure
- Gel nails

- Nail art

Skin and beauty

- Facials
- Eyebrow shaping
- Lash lift and tint

Makeup

- Everyday makeup
- Bridal makeup
- Event makeup

Each service has a **different price and duration**. For example:

- Haircut: about **30 minutes**
- Coloring: **1.5–2 hours**
- Manicure: **45 minutes**
- Facial: **1 hour**

Another important thing is that **not every employee performs every service**, so clients must be booked with the **correct specialist**.

Right now we mostly manage bookings through **phone calls, Instagram messages, and a paper notebook**, which gets messy sometimes.

Lamija:
How do customers currently book appointments?

ChatGPT (Isabella):
Isabella:

Right now it's honestly a bit chaotic. Most appointments come through **three main channels**:

1. Phone calls
This is still the most common way. Clients call the salon, and whoever is at the reception desk checks the **paper appointment notebook** to see if a slot is free. Then we write the client's name, service, and time manually.

2. Instagram messages
Many of our younger clients contact us through **Instagram DMs**. They ask things like:
"Do you have a free slot for a manicure tomorrow?"

Then either I or one of the staff members checks the notebook and replies. Sometimes this causes **double bookings** if two employees respond at the same time.

3. Walk-in clients
Sometimes people just walk in and ask if we have time available. If someone is free, we take them immediately. Otherwise we schedule them for another time.

Problems with the current system

The paper notebook causes several issues:

- Sometimes **appointments overlap** by mistake.
- If the notebook is at the reception desk, **staff can't check it easily from home**.
- It's hard to **see the schedule of each employee clearly**.
- Clients sometimes **forget appointments**, and we have no automatic reminders.
- When the salon is busy, answering Instagram and phone calls takes **a lot of time**.

Ideally, I would love it if clients could **book appointments online themselves**, without us having to answer every message. But I'd still like the staff to be able to **add bookings manually** if someone calls or walks in.

Lamija:
Do you experience any problems with this manual system?

ChatGPT (Isabella):
Oh yes, quite a few actually. The manual system worked when we were smaller, but now it's becoming really difficult to manage.

1. Double bookings

Sometimes two employees accidentally book the **same time slot** for different clients. For example, someone might confirm an appointment through Instagram while another employee writes a different client in the notebook. We only discover the conflict when the clients arrive.

2. Hard to see employee schedules

The notebook shows appointments by **time**, but it's not very clear which employee is busy or free. If a client asks:

"Who is available for a manicure tomorrow afternoon?"
we have to scan through many pages to check.

3. Clients forget appointments

This happens quite often. Clients forget their booking, and the time slot goes unused. We don't currently send **reminders**, so the employee just waits.

4. No client history

We don't keep proper records of clients. Sometimes a customer asks:
"What hair color did I do last time?"
and we have no way to check. It would be helpful to store **client profiles and service history**.

5. Difficult to track payments

Payments are handled at the desk, but we don't have a system that connects **appointments with payments**. At the end of the day we just count everything manually.

6. No reports or statistics

I'd really like to know things like:

- Which **services are most popular**
- Which **employees generate the most revenue**
- How **busy the salon is during the week**

Right now we can't see that information easily.

If you were designing the system, I would especially want it to help with **appointments, reminders, and tracking clients**. Those are the biggest pain points for us right now.

Lamija:
How do you currently manage customer information?

ChatGPT (Isabella):
Right now we don't really manage customer information properly.

Usually we just write the **client's name and sometimes their phone number** in the appointment notebook. Some clients are saved in our **phones or Instagram messages**, but the information is scattered.

We also **don't keep service history**, so we can't see what treatments a client had before.

Ideally, I'd like a system where every client has a **profile with contact info, appointment history, and notes**.

Lamija:
How are payments handled?

ChatGPT (Isabella):
Payments are handled **at the reception after the service**. Most clients pay **in cash**, but some use **card payments** through our POS terminal.

We write the service and price on a **small receipt**, but it's not connected to the appointment system. At the end of the day, we **manually count the total earnings**.

It would be helpful if the system could **track payments automatically and link them to appointments and services**.

Lamija:
Would automated notifications or reminders be useful for customers?

ChatGPT (Isabella):
Yes, that would be very useful. Many clients **forget their appointments**, which leaves empty time slots.

It would be great if the system could send **automatic reminders**, maybe **a day before the appointment** through SMS or email.

That way clients are less likely to forget, and we could also allow them to **cancel or reschedule in advance**.

Lamija:
Would you like customers to be able to book appointments online?

ChatGPT (Isabella):
Yes, definitely. That would make things much easier for us.

I would love if customers could **book appointments online**, choose a **service, date, time, and preferred staff member**, without needing to call or send messages.

But I'd still want the staff to be able to **add or edit appointments manually** for phone calls or walk-in clients.

Lamija:
What kind of reports would be useful for managing the salon?

ChatGPT (Isabella):
A few reports would really help me manage the business better:

- **Daily and monthly revenue** to see how much the salon earns.
- **Most popular services**, so I know what clients request the most.
- **Employee performance**, like how many appointments each staff member has and how much revenue they generate.
- **Busy vs. slow days**, to understand when the salon is most crowded.

These reports would help me make better decisions about **staff schedules and promotions**.

Lamija:
Thank you for the information. This will help us design a system that supports your salon operations.

ChatGPT (Isabella):
You're welcome! I look forward to seeing the proposed solution.